

# Bazaar

We test the latest and the best hardware and software available in the market



digit

PRODUCT OF THE MONTH

APRIL 2002

## AMD ATHLON XP 2000+

### No Stomach for Quake

The AMD Athlon XP 2000+ runs at a 'low' 1.67 GHz! But as amazing as it sounds, it still beats everything out there when it comes to raw performance. This processor is based on the Palomino core that has been fabricated using the tried and tested 0.18-micron process.

The Athlon XP 2000+ broke all previous benchmark records. It took just 6 minutes 40 seconds to complete the POV Ray (ray tracing) test, beating the previous record (7 minutes 2 seconds) and proving its supreme FPU (Floating Point Unit) capabilities. New records were also set in Business Winstone 2001 and Content Creation 2001 with its scores of 60.6 and 84.5 respectively. The processor, however, lagged severely in *Quake III Arena*. The scores here were at least 20 per cent lower than the P4 2.2 GHz. The only disconcerting area was its heat dissipation; although the Palomino core generates a lot less heat, this processor requires a heavy-duty heatsink/fan combination to keep its cool. Also the core is unprotected (unlike the P4, where the core is protected by a metal heat spreader) and calls for careful installation.

**SPECIFICATIONS**  
0.18-micron Palomino core, runs at 1.67 GHz  
**Benchmarks:** 6 minutes and 40 seconds in POV Ray, 60.6 in Business Winstone score, 84.5 in Content Creation 2001 score

|                               |         |
|-------------------------------|---------|
| AMD ATHLON XP 2000+ <b>A-</b> |         |
| Performance                   | ★★★★1/2 |
| Build Quality                 | ★★★★1/2 |
| Value for Money               | ★★★★    |
| Features                      | ★★★★1/2 |
| OVERALL                       | ★★★★    |

**Price:** Rs 20,000  
**Contact:** Avnet Max  
**Phone:** 011-6250250  
**E-mail:** aashish.gupta@avnet.com  
**Web site:** www.amd.com

## Adcom TV Tuner Card

Cable on your PC

Based on the CA8208 chip, this 'tuner only' daughter card lets you watch your favourite TV channels on your PC. Apart from the TV antenna cable port, it also provides you with different ports such as Audio IN, Audio OUT, Video IN, and SVHS IN. The package includes a quick reference



manual and remote control. You can also connect devices such as a camcorder and save your recorded videos on the PC. The card offers decent quality reception and the price is simply irresistible.

**SPECIFICATIONS**  
PCI interface, bundled remote control

|                               |         |
|-------------------------------|---------|
| Adcom TV Tuner Card <b>B+</b> |         |
| Performance                   | ★★★★1/2 |
| Build Quality                 | ★★★★    |
| Value for Money               | ★★★★1/2 |
| Features                      | ★★★★1/2 |
| OVERALL                       | ★★★★1/2 |

**Price:** Rs 2,400  
**Contact:** Advantage Computers Pvt Ltd  
**Phone:** 011-6485384  
**E-mail:** ales@advantagetime.com  
**Web site:** www.advantagetime.com



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**Yatish Suvarna**  
Reviewer, Test Centre

## Though the Athlon XP 2000+ lagged a bit on the gaming front, its score on other parameters propelled it ahead of the competition

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